ARIA NOIR · MAISON

Website review for the build team

Staging site, desktop and mobile · aria-noir-design-staging.vercel.app

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How this deck is organised

01	**Principles**	The three rules behind every note
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05	**People, content and sound**	Real humans, press, journal, music, production
06	**Mobile, then actions**	What works on mobile, then the prioritised list

REFERENCE

Pages referenced in this review

Page	Path	What we discuss
Homepage	/	Hero, six-frame grid, ARCA II feature, “Before it exists”, footer
Shop All	/shop	Product grid, the minimal ARCA I view
ARCA I	/arca-i	Film, old 3D pieces, turntable (mobile)
ARCA II	/arca-ii · /shop/arca-ii	Film, colourways, turntable, try-on, worn images
AHAVA	/ahava	Mood imagery with too little product
PATRIARCA	/patriarca	Opening film, off-brand frames, turntable size
MONARCA · MATRIARCA	/monarca · /matriarca	Need ARCA-standard films
About	/house/about	Motto, real people, the maison
Gallery	/gallery	Keep; make it easy for us to update

01 · PRINCIPLES

Three rules behind every note

Do more with less

When a page gets busy it stops being a symphony and becomes noise.

One frame, given space, beats six crowded together.

Show exactly what they'll get

Every image and film must show our real frames, true to shape and colourway.

Off-brand or inaccurate imagery is the single biggest risk to the business.

Real people behind the maison

No purely AI presentation.

Human models, real faces on About, real packaging, real craft.

01 · PRINCIPLES

What’s working: keep it

- The ARCA I and ARCA II films: chic, dramatic, dark, regal. **The benchmark**
- ARCA II feature flowing into the colourway lightbox on white
- “Frame your mind” hero image
- “Before it exists” image and its hover highlight
- The double-helix 8 motif
- The minimal Shop All view at ARCA I
- The Gallery
- Mobile ARCA II turntable size: perfect as is
- ARCA I mobile opening on a loading image
- The cookie banner and the About page on mobile

01 · PRINCIPLES

The six priorities

1. Every frame gets an ARCA-standard film
2. Replace the six-tile grid with a one-frame-at-a-time carousel
3. Only accurate, on-brand imagery, rebuilt from the 3D source and real photos
4. Bigger, smoother turntables that work on every screen
5. Remove the giant footer wordmark; use the monogram
6. Add the human element: real people, press, journal, careers

02 · HOMEPAGE

Homepage, top to bottom: today vs proposed

Today

- Hero: still image, “Frame your mind”
- **ISSUE** · Six-tile grid: crowded, off-brand images
- ARCA II feature + colourway lightbox
- “Before it exists”: one PATRIARCA image
- The house letter sign-up
- **ISSUE** · Footer with giant ARIA NOIR wordmark
- **ISSUE** · Extra sign-up block after the footer

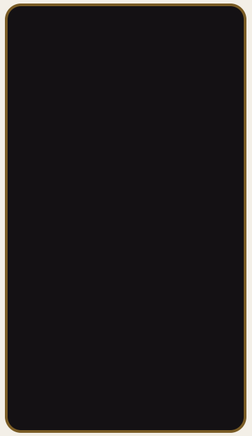
Proposed

- **TEST** · Hero: still, or test a muted film loop
- **NEW** · Auto carousel: one frame at a time, blur
- **KEEP** · ARCA II feature + lightbox on white
- **NEW** · Further frame features, one per section
- **EXPANDED** · “Before it exists”: Eternal 8 + pre-order
- **NEW** · Journal + Instagram feed
- The house letter sign-up
- **CHANGED** · Footer: small monogram above legal links

02 · HOMEPAGE

The carousel: final spec

- Sits directly below the banner
- The six frames, **one at a time**, auto-advancing
- A soft **blur transition** from one frame to the next
- Each slide a short **close-up clip** in the ARCA film style: a thin slice of each frame’s mood
- Minimalist, entertaining, impactful: each frame gets the whole screen
- Clicking a slide opens that frame’s page



Mobile · portrait



Desktop · cinematic

02 · HOMEPAGE / EVERY PAGE

Footer: lose the giant wordmark

Today

An oversized ARIA NOIR wordmark fills the bottom of every page. It’s out of step with high-fashion sites, and the logo is already at the top.

A “Something new is taking shape” sign-up sits after the footer.

Proposed

A small logo variation, such as the monogram, just above Privacy · Terms · Privacy preferences.

Subtle wins. It gives brand recognition through repetition.

Remove the block after the footer. Same on desktop and mobile.

03 · FRAME AND PRODUCT PAGES

Every frame gets an ARCA-standard film

Frame	Today	Needed
ARCA I	Full intro film: the benchmark	Re-crop the one scene that doesn’t fit mobile
ARCA II	Full intro film: the benchmark	Keep
AHAVA	Mood imagery; frames appear only at the end	New film; frames early and often
MONARCA · MATRIARCA	No full intro film	New film for each
PATRIARCA	Opening film, but the frames are off brand	Reshoot or rebuild with our real frames
El Patrón sweaters	Colourways out of date	All five colourways, a film for each

Direction: cinematic, dramatic, high fashion; provocative but elegant. Frankie’s ARCA II shot of the face lit by the glow is the reference.

03 · FRAME AND PRODUCT PAGES

Page-by-page fixes

Page	Issue	Fix
/ahava	Lovely Parisian mood, but the frames barely appear	Lead with product; show frames throughout
/patriarca	Opening film shows off-brand frames	Replace with real frames; turntable at least 25% bigger
/arca-ii	Caramel Stripe renders at a different size	Swap in the new turntable renders
/arca-ii	“Worn · Noir” black-and-white image: colour looks off	Check each image against the real colourway
/arca-ii	AI try-on and mockups are off brand	Rebuild from the 3D source files

03 · FRAME AND PRODUCT PAGES

The 3D turntable

Size

Desktop PATRIARCA: at least 25% bigger. ARCA I mobile: about 15% bigger.

ARCA II mobile is perfect. Leave it.

Quality

Highest resolution possible. We’re paying for top-tier hosting so quality never has to give way to load time.

Use the new renders for every frame.

Motion

No play button (it reads as cheap). It turns slowly on its own when in view, stops when grabbed, and stays still for “reduce motion” users.

Reliability

Snap to the store section so it works straight away.

Must work in landscape on mobile, where today it disappears.

03 · FRAME AND PRODUCT PAGES

What we show is what they get

Stop

Off-brand AI try-on and mockup images

Old, incorrect 3D models with bad lighting

AI images with shifted colour

Mood shots with no product in them

Start

Imagery rebuilt from the 3D source files

Macro, close-up shots from the real product photos in the dashboard

Real packaging and carrying-case photos: one perfect crop says it all

Every image checked against the physical frame before it ships

03 · FRAME AND PRODUCT PAGES / /SHOP

Shop All and tiled images

The grid today

Each frame sits in its own environment, but crowded together the products look cheapened.

No single frame gets the dignity it needs.

The fix, site-wide

Fewer, larger images.

Real white-space margins between every tile. Each image is its own aperture into a different world; margin is what makes it editorial.

Keep: the quiet view

Scroll to ARCA I: logo, menu, a cropped banner in white, products below. Exceptionally elegant.

Lean into it as a second way to browse: the cinematic house and the quiet showroom.

What we call things

Level	Term	Example
The brand	The Maison	ARIA NOIR: we are a fashion house
Everything we sell	The Collection	“Our collection”
Each design	Frame	ARCA II, MONARCA
Each version	Colourway	Noir, Dark Tortoise, Velvet Rose
The yearly core range	The Eternal 8	Eight frames, released in new versions every year

Motto: “By designers, for designers.” Not “for visionaries”. **Nav:** “Collections” becomes “Frames” or “The Collection”; “The House” becomes “The Maison”.

The Eternal 8 and pre-orders

1

Show

Turntable renders of the new Eternal 8, slated for production in the new year. Proof the line is real and coming.

2

Reserve

Pre-order with a benefit: early access to that year’s limited edition, through Jai’s relationships.

3

Register

Each pre-ordered frame gets a numbered digital certificate of authenticity. Special to own, hard to fake.

Copy note: say “digital certificate” or “registered edition” on the site. Keep the word “NFT” out of customer-facing copy.

04 · BRAND AND STORY

The story: sources and guardrails

The book

A ghostwritten coffee-table book about the brand.

The source of truth for all site copy. Showcase it as a Book or lookbook page.

Jai to send.

The making

Milled acetate, gold-plated emblems, hand finishing.

Made with G-Force Optical in Wenzhou and a US partner (name to confirm).

The 888

Inscribed inside the temples of every frame, with deep meaning in gematria.

Ties to the 8 motif on the site and to the Eternal 8.

Don’t claim yet: 18K gold · CE · UV400 · Rx-ready · unqualified “handmade” · “sustainable”. None of these has proof on file.

04 · BRAND AND STORY / DRAFT COPY

The making: draft for frame and About pages

> *Made slowly, on purpose.*
>
> Each ARIA NOIR frame begins as a solid block of cellulose acetate, a plant-based material. It is milled to our drawings, not poured into a mould, then shaped, tumbled for days and polished by hand.
>
> Our emblem is a separate, gold-plated piece set into the acetate. It needs its own tooling, plating and fitting, which is why our frames can’t be made quickly or in bulk.
>
> We don’t make many. That’s the point. Fewer frames, made properly, meant to be worn for years.

05 · PEOPLE, CONTENT AND SOUND

Real people and real content

About

Real people, not an AI presentation. Human models across the site.

Careers

A careers section.

Press

A low-key footer link. Prominent “As seen in” only for genuine editorial.

Journal

Articles from newsletter content. Builds domain authority, and lays the ground for relaunching *Éternité* magazine in print.

Instagram and galleries

A tiled feed. Galleries we can update ourselves.

Architecture, later

For a future ARIA NOIR hotel. Plan the space now.

05 · PEOPLE, CONTENT AND SOUND

Music and production

Music

The track on the latest film isn’t right.

For ARCA’s cold, dark look, the reference is the Silent Hill 1 and 2 soundtracks (Akira Yamaoka): dark harmonics, resonance, heart-wrenching instrumentals.

Mood reference only. Commission or license original music.

Our assets

Jai’s own soundtrack, published on Instagram, and the related videos are brand assets.

Archive them properly and use them across the site and films.

Production

Recast and reshoot with real models and actors, in Ukraine or Spain.

Scope it: brief, casting, location, budget, timeline.

06 · MOBILE

Mobile: strong already

Works

· Cookie banner, and “Frame your mind”
· ARCA II into the lightbox: the best moment on mobile
· ARCA II turntable size
· Worn shots, description and details look chic
· About looks better than on desktop

Fix

· Carousel in portrait, with motion blur
· Macro, close-up product shots
· Price font looks like Courier: bring it into the serif and sans-serif system
· Footer monogram, no giant wordmark

06 · MOBILE / /ARCA-I

ARCA I on mobile: “Built from the shadows”

Issue	Fix
One film scene doesn’t fit the mobile frame	Re-crop it
Two 3D pieces mid-page: old models, bad lighting, off brand	Remove both
The turntable only responds after scrolling past a certain point	After the dark-to-light transition, snap to the store section
The turntable is hard to see	About 15% bigger
In landscape the turntable disappears	Make it work in both orientations

The opening loading image is suspenseful and the crop works. This artistic direction is exactly right.

THE BAR

An award-winning site the fashion world is glad to welcome.

Prices will rise with the more complex models. Every page should carry a higher price point.

ACTIONS

Prioritised checklist

Now

· Carousel to the final spec
· Film briefs: AHAVA, MONARCA, MATRIARCA, PATRIARCA, El Patrón
· Replace off-brand imagery and old 3D pieces
· Footer monogram; remove the trailing block
· Restore the motto
· Turntables: new renders, size, snap, landscape

Next

· Extend the homepage with frame features
· White space on every tiled image
· Eternal 8 pre-order and certificate
· Naming rollout: Maison, Frame, Colourway
· Price font
· Real packaging photos; plan the unboxing

Then

· Journal, Press, Careers, Instagram feed
· Galleries we can edit
· Music brief; scope the reshoot
· The making copy, once facts are confirmed
· Space for Architecture

NEXT STEPS

Questions and hand-offs

Questions for the team

· Hero: still, film, or both? Your recommendation.

· Cost and timing for the new frame films.

· Can the tiles be re-graded from existing footage, or do they need a new shoot?

· Who owns the image-accuracy check before anything ships?

From Jai

· The brand book

· Turntable renders (already shared for download)

· Dashboard photo sets: product, macro, packaging

· Soundtrack files

· The US factory’s name and site